Transaction Monitoring | Case TM-01

Ihab Diab | Independent simulated learning project | Synthetic data only

Scenario

Synthetic profile: Cedar Market (C001), retail, medium assigned risk; expected monthly activity $5,200. The synthetic transaction file contains four cash deposits dated August 12–15, 2026.

Observed evidence

Deposits: $9,200; $9,450; $9,700; and $9,350. Combined total: **$37,700** across four days. The total exceeds the profile's fictional expected monthly activity, creating an exception to review.

Analysis

The clustered size and frequency could be consistent with activity requiring further inquiry. These amounts alone do not prove structuring or illegal conduct. The $9,000 spreadsheet threshold is an illustrative filter, not a legal reporting threshold.

Decision — simulated

Escalate for further review with dates, values, customer profile comparison, and a request for source-of-funds context, account history, and business cash-volume explanation. Do not assert that a SAR is required based on the synthetic evidence alone.

Tools and reproducibility

Refer to workbooks/AML_Transaction_Monitoring_Practice.xlsx and data/transactions.csv; filter for C001 and dates August 12–15. Columns H and I contain VLOOKUP customer profile fields.

Disclosure: This document is a fictional training exercise. No real customers, sanctioned parties, bank systems, regulatory filings, or professional AML investigations were involved.